

The Shade Shed

A model persuasive proposal: clear enough for an audience to decide.

An unused corner can still be a choice

At lunch, the strip beside Harbourview's library is often empty. It is too bright for reading and too narrow for a game, so students pass it on their way to the oval. Maia sees something different: a small covered space with benches, a noticeboard and a crate of drawing materials that students can use during lunch.

Harbourview should trial a Shade Shed beside the library for one term, then review whether it gives students a calm and useful lunchtime choice.

First, the shed would give students a place to read, draw, talk quietly or wait for a friend without having to join a noisy game. A school playground should offer more than one way to belong. The proposal does not ask students to stop playing sport; it adds one small option to an unused space.

A careful proposal anticipates questions

Some people may worry that a shed could cost too much, become messy or need extra supervision. Those are reasonable concerns. A space that staff cannot manage fairly would not solve the problem it is meant to address.

However, a short trial could begin with existing benches, a simple use-and-return routine and a weekly check-in with the duty teacher. The school could record which materials are used, what needs repair and whether the space is manageable before deciding whether to continue.

Mark the model

- H** hook: invites a reader into the situation
- T** thesis: states a position and action
- R** reason: explains why the action matters
- O** other view: fair concern
- C** conclusion: measured next step

Find the thesis. Underline one reason. Put a box around the fair concern.

What the model does

A persuasive writer makes a claim, then gives the audience reasons to consider it.

Different sentences, different jobs

The proposal returns to its main point at the end: Harbourview should trial the Shade Shed, collect information during the term and decide what to do next. This conclusion is not a promise that every student will enjoy the shed. It is a request for a limited action that an audience can evaluate.

The model also avoids pretending that one feeling is evidence. Maia's observation creates a reason to investigate a need; it does not prove that the school should spend money. A writer would still need to find reliable information, listen to different views and explain where the information came from.

Three beginnings

Only a topic

"Shade and lunch."

Vague wish

"The school needs something better outside."

Researchable claim

"The principal should approve a one-term Shade Shed trial beside the library."

Overclaim

"The Shade Shed will fix every playground problem."

Before you choose your own idea

Name an audience with a real decision to make. State what should happen. Then list the questions you will need to research. Your claim can change after you learn more.

Writer's questions

Who can act on this proposal?

Which sentence gives the action?

What information would make the reason stronger?

Your task: choose a school or community idea that is appropriate to investigate. You may change the idea after research.